TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 11

Date: | **Supervisor:**

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Cordless Drill & Impact Driver Safe Use

OVERVIEW:

Cordless drills and impact drivers are the most-used tools on any finish carpentry crew. Their familiarity can cause complacency, but they are still capable of causing serious injuries. Bit slippage, torque kickback, and flying debris are the most common hazards, all of which are preventable

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Bit selection is the first line of safety with a drill or impact driver. Using a bit that is the wrong size, the wrong drive type, or worn and stripped will cause it to slip out of the fastener head under load. A slipping bit can skate across a finished surface, punch through thin material, or drive your hand into the work. Always match the bit to the fastener and replace worn bits before
2. Torque kickback is a risk with high-powered drills when the bit binds suddenly — such as when a screw bottoms out, a bit hits a hidden nail, or a hole saw grabs in material. The tool body rotates instead of the bit, and if your wrist is not braced for it, a sprain or fracture can result. When drilling with large bits or high-torque settings, always grip the tool firmly, position your body
3. Overhead drilling and driving is especially hazardous for your eyes. Debris, dust, chips, and broken bits fall directly into your face when working overhead. Safety glasses are not enough — use close-fitting safety glasses or goggles for any overhead drilling operation. This applies to installing blocking, drilling for wire runs, and anchoring overhead cabinets.
4. Battery and charger safety matters. Lithium-ion batteries that are damaged, swollen, or cracked can thermal-run and cause fire. Inspect batteries before charging. Never charge a damaged battery, and never leave batteries on a charger unattended in an enclosed space overnight. If a battery becomes hot during use or charging, disconnect it and place it outside on a non-combustible surface until

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

Q1: What do you do if your drill bit strips out in a fastener head and you cannot remove the screw?

Q2: Has anyone experienced torque kickback with a drill or impact driver? What happened?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Select the correct bit — stripped or wrong-size bits cause slippage
- Use a clutch setting appropriate to the fastener and material
- Wear eye protection when drilling overhead or into masonry
- Secure small workpieces before drilling — never hold by hand only
- Inspect cords and batteries for damage before each use

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.

CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 11

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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